

My Plan

DevOps/DevSecOps Career Roadmap — Scott Pattison

My goal is a career in DevOps/DevSecOps — entry level, based around Andover/Basingstoke/Southampton, accessible by public transport, open to remote.

Updated 16 June 2026 following Misha van den Burg's Kubecraft roadmap session.

Stage-by-Stage Learning Roadmap

Misha's roadmap session laid out a sequential path from Linux fundamentals through to cloud and CI/CD. The seven stages below map that path against my certification targets and homelab build, in the order it was presented — this is the answer to “what do I learn next.”

Stage 1 — Linux Fundamentals

Topics: systemd, permissions, the filesystem hierarchy, Bash scripting.

Status: Underway — Misha's free and advanced Linux courses both completed; Linux+ study in progress.

Maps to: CompTIA Linux+, with foundational overlap into Security+.

Stage 2 — Containers: Docker & Podman

Topics: images, containers, volumes, Docker networking, writing Dockerfiles, Podman as the rootless alternative.

Status: Practical exposure already — Jellyfin runs via Docker on nezuko. Next step: author and maintain my own Dockerfiles rather than just running other people's images.

Maps to: Docker Certified Associate (longer term).

Stage 3 — Kubernetes

Topics: pods, deployments, services, ingress, k3s (the lightweight distro suited to homelab/edge hardware).

Status: Not started. Build target: a real multi-node cluster across nezuko, MilimNava (Pi 5), and shalltear (Proxmox VMs) — the headline “Proof” piece in the employment equation below.

Maps to: Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA, longer term).

Stage 4 — Cloud

Topics: AWS core services, cloud networking (VPCs, subnets, security groups).

Status: Not started.

Maps to: AWS Cloud Practitioner.

Stage 5 — Programming (Basics)

Topics: scripting for automation — likely Python, building on the data-collector scripts already written for the Wight Trading Enterprise project.

Status: Not started as formal study, though some practical Python already written.

Maps to: Supports CySA+ and automation work across every other stage.

Stage 6 — CI/CD

Topics: CI with GitHub Actions; CD with Flux (GitOps — cluster state lives in git, Flux syncs it automatically).

Status: Not started. A natural extension of the existing git add/commit/push discipline into infrastructure.

Maps to: Strengthens the Kubernetes “Proof” piece — a cluster managed via GitOps reads stronger than one configured by hand.

Stage 7 — Networking

Topics: CIDR/subnetting, container networking, cloud networking.

Status: Practical exposure already — Tailscale setup, SSH log auditing, and netplan troubleshooting on nezuko.

Maps to: Supports CompTIA Network+ (currently marked possible in the certification roadmap below).

Certification Roadmap

- ✓ ~~Misha van den Burg's Free Linux Course~~ (Completed)
- ✓ ~~Misha van den Burg's Advanced Linux Course~~ (Completed)
- CompTIA Linux+ (In progress)
- CompTIA Security+
- CompTIA Network+ (Possible)
- AWS Cloud Practitioner
- CySA+
- Docker Certified Associate (Longer term)
- Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) (Longer term)

Path to Employment: Tech × Reach × Proof

From the roadmap session: getting hired is a function of three multiplied factors — being weak in any one undermines the whole equation, no matter how strong the others are.

- **Tech** — the certification roadmap above.
- **Reach** — visibility: LinkedIn, the Skool community, and general networking. Posting progress publicly, as already happening via Skool, counts here.

- **Proof** — demonstrable, working evidence: this homelab, with the Kubernetes cluster as the flagship piece, backed by the study notes and incident report already in this repo.

Also flagged: communication, presentation, and negotiation skills matter alongside the technical equation — worth practising deliberately rather than treating as a side effect of the technical work.

Kubecraft

Misha's Kubecraft Career Accelerator is the natural next step from his courses — it combines technical training with mentorship, accountability, community, and job hunting strategy. For a career changer in their 50s, that structured support is genuinely valuable and hard to replicate independently. Cost makes it unlikely in the near term, but it's an ongoing programme — joining at a later date remains an option and is very much still on the table.

Alternatives to Kubecraft

If Kubecraft isn't possible in the near term, the plan is to build the same skills through other routes:

Resource	Focus	Cost
KubeAcademy	Kubernetes fundamentals	Free
School of Kubernetes	Hands-on Kubernetes	Free
A Cloud Guru	Cloud & DevOps broad coverage	Low cost
Linux Foundation (LFS courses)	Linux, containers, Kubernetes	Free/paid
TechWorld with Nana (YouTube)	DevOps toolchain, real projects	Free
roadmap.sh/devops	Structured DevOps learning path	Free
The homelab itself	Practical everything	Already paid for